supports Razor Pages development, and there is a free Community edition available.

Visual Studio Code (VS Code) is a popular, free cross-platform code editor (as opposed to a development environment). A huge and growing number of extensions are available that make .NET Core development within VS Code quite easy, including C# language integration, debugging, and version control integration. VS Code doesn't include the same kind of tooling integration for working with Razor Pages offered by Visual Studio, but it does feature an integrated terminal, providing easy access to the .NET CLI, and the awesome OmniSharp extension provides excellent support for C# development in VS Code. How to use the VS Code terminal to execute CLI commands will be discussed throughout this book; you can download VS Code from https://code.visualstudio.com/.

If you want to develop on a Mac or Linux system, VS Code is a good option. Alternatively, Rider from JetBrains is a cross-platform .NET IDE, which offers a 30-day free trial.

Throughout this book, I will show you how to use Visual Studio Community Edition and VS Code to develop a Razor Pages application, but you can follow the examples regardless of which platform you choose to work with.

1.5.3 Choosing a database system

Web applications need a means by which they can persist data. ASP.NET Core doesn't impose any technical limits on your options. You could store data as a series of text files if you wanted, but the most commonly used data store is a relational database of some kind. You also need a means to establish connections between your application and the database, execute database commands, and access any resulting data. .NET 6 includes a low-